

TASC Standards & Key Terms — Sample Reference

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What is the TCE?

The Tasmanian Certificate of Education (TCE) is the qualification awarded to students who meet Tasmania's senior secondary standards. To be awarded a TCE, a student generally needs to reach the Everyone Standards (a set literacy and numeracy benchmark) and accumulate enough credit points from completed courses, with a mix of course levels.

What do TASC levels mean?

Courses are labelled Level 1 to Level 4, roughly indicating difficulty and depth of study. Level 1 and 2 courses are introductory or foundational. Level 3 courses are the standard senior secondary level most commonly used for university entry (ATAR) calculations. Level 4 courses are the most advanced, sometimes offered in partnership with the University of Tasmania.

What is the ATAR?

The Australian Tertiary Admission Rank (ATAR) is a number between 0 and 99.95 that ranks a student's overall academic achievement against other students in their year. Universities use the ATAR, alongside any specific subject prerequisites, as one factor in course entry decisions. Only certain Level 3 and Level 4 courses count towards an ATAR calculation.

What is VET?

Vocational Education and Training (VET) courses lead to nationally recognised qualifications (such as a Certificate II or III) rather than an ATAR score. VET can be studied alongside academic subjects and often includes practical, workplace-based learning. It's a strong pathway into a trade, traineeship, or direct employment, and some VET qualifications also provide credit toward further TAFE or university study.

What is the UCP (University Connections Program)?

The University Connections Program lets eligible senior secondary students study a first-year university unit while still enrolled at college, giving them a head start on their degree and a taste of university-level study before they finish Year 12.